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Companies' Numbers in OTC segment



CIPLA: Domestic sales grew 12% in FY24, due to expansion in OTC products like wellness, dermatology, and nutraceuticals

SUN PHARMA: 10% annual growth, driven by growth in products like vitamins, supplements, and dermatology

LUPIN: 12% annual growth, driven by expanding its OTC offerings, like vitamins and dietary supplements

GLENMARK: 10% annual growth, largely due to new OTC product launches in wellness and dermatology

SOURCE COMPANY DOCUMENTS

played a significant role in the company's overall performance. CHL also acquired the brand Endura Mass, designed to address consumer needs for weight gain and muscle building. In keeping with the trend, Bayer's consumer health division has also grown significantly in recent years. In the third quarter of 2024, sales increased by 5.7% (foreign exchange and portfolio adjusted) to €1,413 million, (approximately ₹12,770 crore). Bayer's product offerings, including Saridon Woman, Saridon Head & Body, and Bepanthen, aim to address common health issues like menstrual pain and skincare. Supradyn, a multivitamin, is designed to combat fatigue.

"With 96% of Indians acknowledging a lack of essential micro-nutrients, Supradyn is designed to provide the energy boost needed," Verma of Bayer says.

However, doctors are uneasy about the increased consumption of these drugs. "While OTC multivitamins are commonly used, taking them without professional guidance can be problematic. Many individuals opt for them for preventive purposes without understanding the proper dosage or potential interactions with other medications," says Dr. Ajay Agarwal. "The overuse of these supplements can lead to unnecessary health risks, particularly when used in combination with other treatments without consulting a healthcare professional," he says.

ALL SUNSHINE?

India's OTC drug market is facing significant regulatory challenges in the absence of a formal legal framework for these widely used medications ranging from paracetamol tablets to cough suppressants. Fewer regulatory constraints allow

ments," Lupin's Kaushal says.

The global nutraceuticals market is projected to grow at a 7.8% CAGR from 2023 to 2030, reaching a valuation of approximately \$650 billion by 2030, while the Indian market is expanding at a double-digit CAGR, according to market research platforms Grand View

Research and Market Research Future. In FY24, Cipla Health Ltd (CHL), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Cipla, crossed ₹1,000 crore in revenue, driven by its presence in key wellness segments, including soar throat and cough relief, pain recovery, and nicotine replacement therapy. These product categories